

Sloth

Searchable transcript

****Author:**** Eric Carle

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Source: `"\_Slowly, slowly, slowly,"\_ said the sloth -- Eric Carle -- New York, NY, 2002 -- Philomel Books -- 9780142408476 -- 8d6a2ef694b9bf2ef89bd6fd0b890ca9 -- Anna's Archive.pdf` (32 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 6-28)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

Slowly, slowly, slowly,
a sloth crawled along
a branch of a tree.

Slowly, slowly, slowly,
the sloth ate a leaf.

Slowly, slowly, slowly,
the sloth fell asleep.

Slowly, slowly, slowly,
the sloth woke up.

All day long
the sloth hung
upside down
in the tree.

All night long
the sloth hung
upside down
in the tree.

Even when it rained
the sloth hung
upside down
in the tree.

'Why are you so slow?'
the howler monkey asked one day.
But the sloth didn't answer.

'Why are you so boring?'
the anteater asked one day.
But the sloth didn't answer.

'Tell me,' said the jaguar,
'why are you so lazy?'

The sloth thought and thought
and thought for a long,
long, long time.

Finally, the sloth replied,

'It is true that I am slow,
 quiet and boring.
 I am lackadaisical,
 I dawdle and I dillydally.
 I am also unflappable,
 languid, stoic, impassive,
 sluggish, lethargic, placid,
 calm, mellow, laid-back
 and, well, slothful!
 I am relaxed and tranquil,
 and I like to live in peace.
 But I am not lazy.'
 Then the sloth yawned and said,
 'That's just how I am.
 I like to do things
 slowly,
 slowly,
 slowly.'

- The opening spreads follow the sloth crawling along a branch, eating a leaf, sleeping, waking, and hanging upside down through day, night and rain.
- Illustration-only spreads show the sloth among toucans, a snake and parrots, a jaguar, a tapir, a tiger, a turtle and ants, a caiman, and an anteater with ants.
- The question spreads pair each animal with its question: the howler monkey asks why the sloth is so slow, the anteater asks why it is so boring, and the jaguar asks why it is so lazy. The sloth gives no answer until the jaguar's question.
- The closing spreads show the sloth thinking for a long time, then delivering its reply about being slow, quiet and boring -- but not lazy -- ending with "slowly, slowly, slowly."
- Back matter names and pictures rainforest animals and closes with an author note beginning "Why are we always in a hurry?"
- Page map: text on PDF pages 6, 8, 10, 12, 14, 16, 18, 20, 22, 24, 26, 27-28.
 Illustration-only (no printed text): pages 7, 9, 11, 13, 15, 17, 19, 21, 23, 25, 29.
- Quotation-mark quirk: the howler-monkey and anteater questions open with a single quotation mark and close with a double one ('Why are you so slow?' / 'Why are you so boring?'); the jaguar's lines and the sloth's reply use single quotation marks throughout. Reproduced as printed.
- Removed: a caiman line ("Why are you so quiet?" the caiman asked) carried over from the first text-layer extraction. No caiman question appears on any story page of this scan -- every page was checked visually -- so it was removed as unverifiable against this source. It may belong to a different edition.
- Added from visual reads: the "ate a leaf" spread (p. 8), the full "All day long" verse (p. 14), the "All night long" verse (p. 16), and the "one day" phrasing on the monkey and anteater questions.

Every story page (PDF pages 6-29) was read visually against 150 dpi renders on 9 September 2026; the story text above is high confidence. Cover and title text, dedication, copyright and

cataloguing data (pages 1-3), the foreword (page 4), animal-name back matter (pages 30-31) and the author note (page 32) are not included as story prose.